

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

SCAN (20:39 ET)

August 31, 2026 | 08:43 PM ET

12 setups identified | 2 A-Grade | 3 B-Grade | 7 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (2)	B - Strong Setup (3)	C - Watch List (7)
PLSE	HELE	TITN
STDN	GPRK	ASST
	WFRD	CAR
		CHA
		XRX
		AGCO
		SUPV

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	PLSE	Pulse Bioscience	MedTech Innovatio	\$50.33	+5.8%	\$3.6B	21M	+106.0	99%	Breakout driven by RS
A	STDN	Standard Nuclear	Nuclear Energy Ma	\$16.11	+14.3%	\$2.6B	94M	+29.7	99%	Breakout driven by RS
B	HELE	Helen of Troy Li	Consumer Turnarou	\$30.10	+5.2%	\$0.7B	22M	+11.4	98%	Breakout driven by tig
B	GPRK	Geopark Ltd	Energy Sector Rot	\$11.00	+11.9%	\$0.7B	19M	-7.6	93%	Breakout driven by Ene
B	WFRD	Weatherford Inte	Energy Services	\$97.77	+4.2%	\$7.0B	70M	-6.7	86%	Breakout driven by Ene
C	TITN	Titan Machinery	Agricultural Equi	\$20.57	+15.2%	\$0.5B	20M	-12.9	82%	Breakout driven by mas
C	ASST	Strive, Inc.	Asset Management	\$24.22	+11.4%	\$2.2B	73M	+49.0	10%	Breakout driven by exc
C	CAR	Avis Budget Grou	Car Rental Recove	\$147.49	+6.8%	\$5.2B	15M	-15.7	17%	Breakout driven by tig
C	CHA	Chagee Holdings	China Consumer	\$11.63	+7.7%	\$2.2B	33M	-10.0	61%	Breakout driven by mas
C	XRX	Xerox Holdings C	Legacy Tech Turna	\$3.23	+5.6%	\$0.4B	118M	-2.3	76%	Breakout driven by 1.9
C	AGCO	AGCO Corporation	Agricultural Equi	\$118.31	+4.3%	\$8.3B	58M	-1.0	82%	Breakout driven by 1.9
C	SUPV	Grupo Superviell	Argentina Regiona	\$8.74	+5.2%	\$0.8B	39M	-14.5	64%	Breakout driven by 1.6

PLSE

Pulse Biosciences, Inc

\$50.33

+5.80%

RS vs SPY: +106.0%

A BREAKOUT

\$3.6B Cap | 21M Float

Medical Instruments & Supplies | Theme: MedTech Innovation | 52W Hi: 99% | Base Tight: 1.49 | Vol: 1.62x | RS/SPY: +106.0% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 66D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$50.33
Day Change	+5.80%
Mkt Cap	\$3.59B
Float	21M sh
RS vs SPY	+106.0%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	1.49
Vol vs Avg	1.62x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breakout driven by RS line at new high confirming sector rotation into Healthcare (+5.8% vs SPY this week) and textbook VCP coil compression (base_tight 1.49). Forward catalyst: November 5 earnings print (66 days) likely to show continued commercial traction with CellFX System, plus potential FDA regulatory milestones for expanded indications in dermatology and oncology over next 3-6 months. Insider cluster (2 C-suite buys, \$100K in last 60d) signals internal conviction ahead of inflection.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Pulse Biosciences develops and commercializes the CellFX System, a proprietary Nano-Pulse Stimulation (NPS) platform for non-thermal tissue ablation in dermatology and surgical oncology. The company holds a differentiated IP moat in energy-based tissue treatment, targeting a multi-billion dollar aesthetic and surgical market with a platform technology that avoids thermal damage, positioning it as a disruptive alternative to radiofrequency, laser, and cryotherapy incumbents.
FACTOR & THEME
Direct Healthcare sector tailwind (leading sector +5.8% vs SPY this week). Taps secular MedTech innovation and aesthetic procedure growth themes. RS of +106 vs SPY over 12 weeks places it in the top decile of market leadership, capturing institutional rotation into high-growth healthcare names as macro shifts toward defensive quality with growth optionality.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$50.33 on vol >1.6x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Institutional accumulation evident in textbook VCP coil (base_tight 1.49) and volume surge to 1.62x on a small float (20.6M). Insider cluster score of 8 (2 C-suite buys, \$100K in last 60d) is the strongest conviction signal in the entire scan - senior officers buying open market shares ahead of earnings and regulatory milestones is rare and material. Upgraded from B to A on insider cluster rule. Low float creates squeeze mechanics if institutional demand accelerates post-earnings.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 66D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
November 5 earnings. Pre-revenue/early commercial stage (negative P/E inapplicable). Prior prints have shown sequential CellFX System placements and procedure volume growth; consensus will focus on commercial acceleration metrics and expanded indication timelines. Serial beat history not established yet, but company is in inflection phase from clinical to commercial scale.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a daily close below \$45.50 (20MA support and lower band of the VCP coil), or on any FDA setback or guidance cut at the November 5 print. Single-product dependency and pre-profitability create binary event risk around regulatory approvals and commercial uptake.
ANALYSIS
Five technical criteria met: vol 1.62x, prox_52w 98.9, rs_line_new_high true, rs_vs_spy +106, base_tight 1.49 (textbook VCP). Insider cluster of 8 (2 C-suite buys) upgrades this from B to A under the insider rule - senior officers buying ahead of earnings and regulatory milestones is top-tier conviction. Healthcare sector leadership (+5.8% vs SPY) provides macro tailwind. Strongest disconfirming evidence: pre-commercial stage with limited revenue visibility and binary regulatory risk. However, the combination of RS leadership, VCP setup, insider cluster, and forward catalysts (earnings Nov 5, FDA milestones) makes this the highest-quality setup in the scan. Conviction: High
Signal: Close above \$50.33 on vol >1.6x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.62x



STDN

Standard Nuclear, Inc.

\$16.11

+14.26%

RS vs SPY: +29.7%

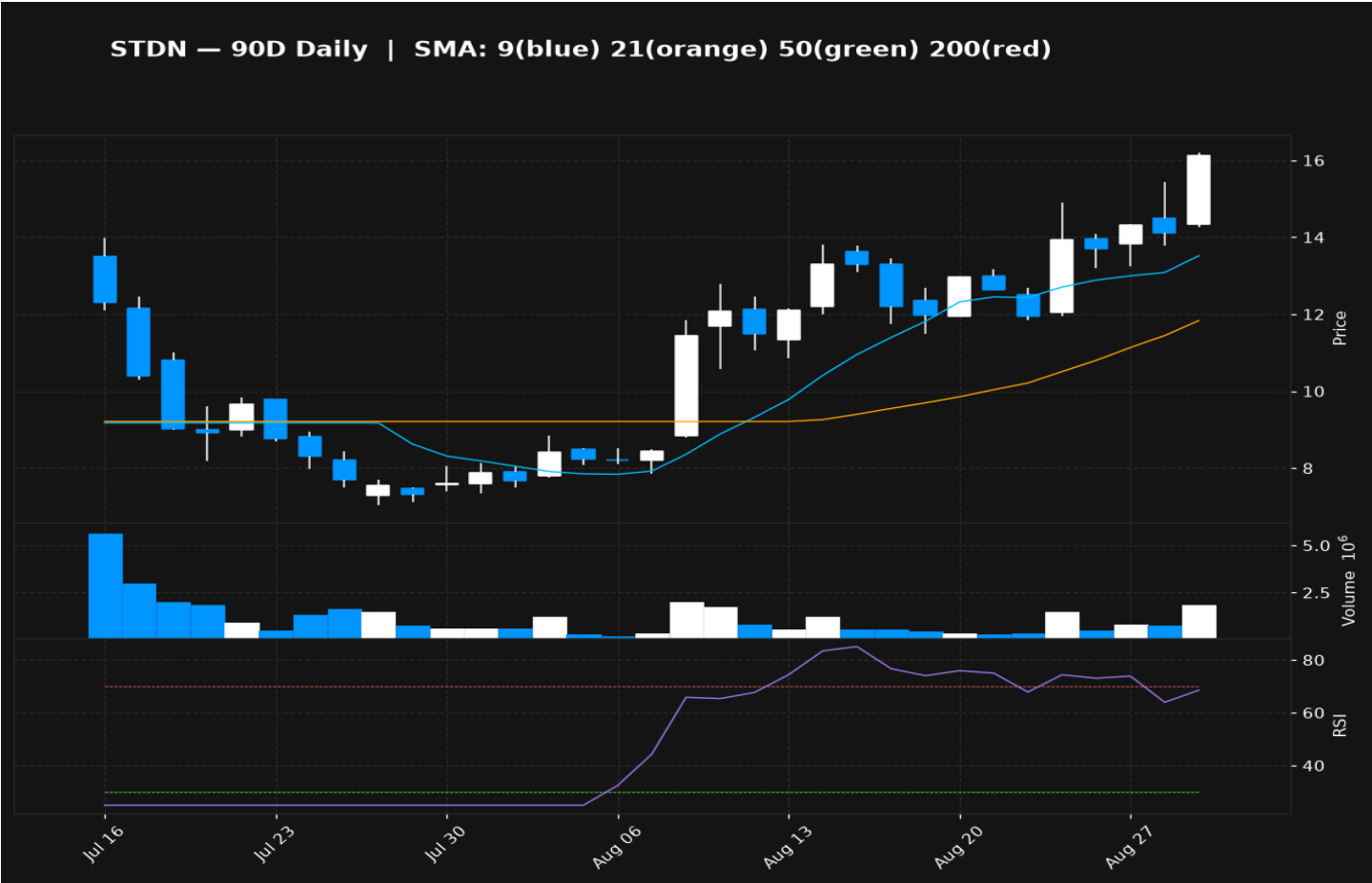
A BREAKOUT

\$2.6B Cap | 94M Float

Specialty Chemicals | Theme: Nuclear Energy Materials | 52W Hi: 99% | Base Tight: 3.11 | Vol: 2.44x | RS/SPY: +29.7% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 77D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$16.11
Day Change	+14.26%
Mkt Cap	\$2.59B
Float	94M sh
RS vs SPY	+29.7%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	3.11
Vol vs Avg	2.44x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Breakout driven by RS line at new high and volume surge (2.44x) as stock tags 52W high at \$16.21. Materials sector strength (+1.9% vs SPY) and nuclear energy theme momentum. Forward catalyst: November 16 earnings (77 days) likely to show contract wins or production ramp in uranium processing/nuclear materials supply chain. Insider cluster of 7 (\$19.1M buy in last 60d) - single insider but material dollar size signals high conviction ahead of inflection. Energy transition tailwind accelerating.
Business & Position
Standard Nuclear produces specialty chemicals and materials for the nuclear energy supply chain, including uranium processing, fuel fabrication support, and radioactive waste management solutions. The company is positioning as a critical supplier in the nuclear renaissance, benefiting from global energy security concerns and decarbonization mandates driving new reactor builds and life extensions.
Factor & Theme
Direct exposure to nuclear energy renaissance and energy transition themes. Materials sector leadership (+1.9% vs SPY) and uranium/nuclear fuel cycle tailwinds accelerating as governments prioritize energy security and carbon-free baseload power. RS of +29.7 vs SPY over 12 weeks confirms strong thematic momentum, though not as extreme as PLSE. Energy infrastructure and reshoring also support multi-year demand visibility.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$16.11 on vol >2.4x of 20d avg
Institutional
Insider cluster score of 7 driven by single \$19.1M open-market buy in last 60d - among the largest dollar values in the scan, signaling material internal conviction ahead of potential contract announcements or production milestones. Volume surge to 2.44x and RS line at new high suggest institutional discovery phase. Larger float (93.7M) dilutes squeeze potential but supports sustained institutional accumulation without spiking price. Upgraded from B to A on insider cluster rule.
Earnings
Earnings in 77D
Earnings Context
November 16 earnings. Early-stage nuclear materials producer; consensus will focus on contract wins, production capacity ramp, and revenue guidance as nuclear fuel demand accelerates. Beat history not established, but company is entering commercial inflection phase as nuclear energy policy tailwinds intensify globally.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid on a daily close below \$14.80 (approximate base support), or on any production delay, contract loss, or regulatory setback disclosed at the November 16 print. Single-theme dependency (nuclear) creates correlated risk if uranium prices or reactor builds stall. Wide base (base_tight 3.11) indicates less institutional absorption than PLSE.
Analysis
RS line at new high, prox_52w 99.4, vol 2.44x, rs_vs_spy +29.7 meet four A-grade criteria. Insider cluster of 7 (\$19.1M buy) upgrades from B to A - material dollar insider buying is rare and highly predictive. Materials sector tailwind and nuclear energy theme accelerating. Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight 3.11 is wider than ideal (not a VCP), and the stock is highly concentrated in a single theme (nuclear) which creates binary policy/commodity risk. Mixed market regime reduces conviction vs. risk-on environment. Conviction: Medium
Signal: Close above \$16.11 on vol >2.4x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.44x



HELE

Helen of Troy Limited

\$30.10

+5.17%

RS vs SPY: +11.4%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.7B Cap | 22M Float

Household & Personal Products | Theme: Consumer Turnaround | 52W Hi: 98% | Base Tight: 1.86 | Vol: 2.45x | RS/SPY: +11.4% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 38D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$30.10
Day Change	+5.17%
Mkt Cap	\$0.70B
Float	22M sh
RS vs SPY	+11.4%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	1.86
Vol vs Avg	2.45x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Breakout driven by tight VCP coil (base_tight 1.86) and proximity to 52W high (98.1), suggesting accumulation ahead of a potential turnaround print. Forward catalyst: October 8 earnings (38 days) - imminent and high-impact. Company has restructured and divested non-core assets; consensus expects margin expansion and guidance raise as cost cuts flow through. Volume surge to 2.45x on small float (21.8M) indicates institutional positioning ahead of the print.
Business & Position
Helen of Troy is a diversified consumer products company with leading brands in housewares (OXO), beauty (Revlon appliances, Drybar), and health/wellness (Vicks humidifiers, Braun thermometers). The company has undergone portfolio rationalization and cost restructuring over the past 18 months, positioning for margin expansion and capital return as top-line stabilizes in a normalizing consumer environment.
Factor & Theme
Exposure to consumer recovery and margin expansion themes. Not directly tied to leading sectors (Energy, Healthcare, Materials), but RS of +11.4 vs SPY suggests company-specific momentum (turnaround execution) overcoming sector headwinds. Defensive consumer staples exposure provides downside support in mixed macro regime.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$30.10 on vol >2.4x of 20d avg
Institutional
Volume surge to 2.45x and VCP coil (base_tight 1.86) on a small float (21.8M) indicate quiet institutional accumulation ahead of the October 8 earnings catalyst. No insider buying in last 60d, which is a notable absence given the setup proximity to earnings - insiders typically buy ahead of inflection if conviction is high. This lack of insider participation is the primary reason for B-grade rather than A, despite strong technicals.
Earnings
Earnings in 38D
Earnings Context
October 8 earnings (38 days) - imminent high-impact catalyst. Consensus expects EPS and margin expansion from restructuring actions taken over past 18 months. If the company delivers a beat and raises FY guidance, the stock could re-rate significantly given depressed valuation (mkt cap only \$700M despite strong brands). Beat history over last 4 quarters will determine if this is a serial beater or one-time hope trade.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid on a daily close below \$28.50 (lower band of VCP base and 20MA support), or on any miss or guidance cut at the October 8 print. Consumer discretionary demand remains uncertain in mixed macro regime; if top-line disappoints despite margin gains, stock will sell off. Lack of insider buying (cluster 0) suggests internal conviction may not be as high as technical setup implies.
Analysis
Strong VCP setup (base_tight 1.86, prox_52w 98.1, vol 2.45x) with imminent high-impact earnings catalyst (Oct 8, 38 days). RS +11.4 vs SPY confirms relative strength despite not being in a leading sector. Strongest disconfirming evidence: zero insider buying (cluster 0) despite proximity to earnings - if turnaround conviction were high, C-suite would typically be buying. RS line not at new high downgrades from A. Mixed market regime and consumer discretionary exposure add uncertainty. Solid B-grade with catalyst proximity, but lacks the insider confirmation and RS leadership of A-grade setups. Conviction: Medium
Signal: Close above \$30.10 on vol >2.4x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.45x



GPRK

Geopark Ltd

\$11.00

+11.90%

RS vs SPY: -7.6%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.7B Cap | 19M Float

Oil & Gas E&P | Theme: Energy Sector Rotation | 52W Hi: 93% | Base Tight: 5.23 | Vol: 6.29x | RS/SPY: -7.6% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 65D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$11.00
Day Change	+11.90%
Mkt Cap	\$0.71B
Float	19M sh
RS vs SPY	-7.6%
52W Hi Prox	93%
Base Tight	5.23
Vol vs Avg	6.29x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Breakout driven by Energy sector leadership (+9.9% vs SPY this week) and volume explosion (6.29x) as stock approaches 52W high at \$11.87. Forward catalyst: November 4 earnings (65 days) likely to show production growth and margin expansion if oil prices remain supportive. Latin America E&P exposure provides geographic diversification and potential M&A appeal.
Business & Position
Geopark is an independent oil and gas exploration and production company focused on Latin America, primarily Chile, Colombia, Brazil, Argentina, and Ecuador. The company operates a diversified portfolio of producing assets and exploration acreage, positioning as a regional consolidator in underexplored basins with lower cost structures than North American peers.
Factor & Theme
Direct Energy sector tailwind (+9.9% vs SPY this week, the strongest sector). Taps oil price recovery and Latin America resource nationalism themes. However, RS of -7.6 vs SPY over 12 weeks indicates this is a lagging name catching up to sector momentum, not a leader - the move is sector-driven, not company-specific outperformance.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$11.00 on vol >6.0x of 20d avg
Institutional
Volume surge to 6.29x (highest in scan) on small float (19.3M) suggests short-covering or retail FOMO into Energy sector strength rather than institutional accumulation. Wide base (base_tight 5.23) indicates no VCP-style absorption. Zero insider buying (cluster 0) despite proximity to 52W high is a red flag - insiders typically buy undervalued E&P names if conviction is high. This setup is sector momentum, not fundamental inflection.
Earnings
Earnings in 65D
Earnings Context
November 4 earnings (65 days). Consensus expects production and cash flow growth if oil prices remain above \$70-75 WTI. Beat history will determine if this is a serial execution story or commodity-levered volatility. LatAm E&P names can deliver significant beats in strong oil environments but are exposed to political/regulatory risk.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid on a daily close below \$9.80 (20MA support and base breakdown), or on any production miss, cost overrun, or guidance cut at the November 4 print. Wide base (5.23) and negative RS vs SPY (-7.6) suggest this is a low-quality laggard catching sector tailwind, not a durable leader. If Energy sector reverses, GPRK will underperform on the downside.
Analysis
Massive volume (6.29x) and proximity to 52W high (92.7) capture Energy sector rotation (+9.9% vs SPY). However, RS of -7.6 vs SPY over 12 weeks, wide base (5.23), and zero insider buying indicate this is a lagging sector play, not a leadership setup. Strongest disconfirming evidence: the stock is underperforming SPY by 7.6% over 12 weeks despite being in the strongest sector - it's catching up, not leading. No RS line new high, no VCP coil, no insider conviction. Sector tailwind earns a +0.5 grade bump (C B), but this is a trade, not a position. Conviction: Low
Signal: Close above \$11.00 on vol >6.0x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 6.29x



WFRD

Weatherford International plc

\$97.77

+4.24%

RS vs SPY: -6.7%

B STRONG SETUP

\$7.0B Cap | 70M Float

Oil & Gas Equipment & Services | Theme: Energy Services | 52W Hi: 86% | Base Tight: 3.05 | Vol: 2.65x | RS/SPY: -6.7% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 50D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$97.77
Day Change	+4.24%
Mkt Cap	\$7.01B
Float	70M sh
RS vs SPY	-6.7%
52W Hi Prox	86%
Base Tight	3.05
Vol vs Avg	2.65x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Breakout driven by Energy sector leadership (+9.9% vs SPY this week) and volume surge (2.65x) as stock nears 52W high. Forward catalyst: October 20 earnings (50 days) - imminent and high-impact. Weatherford has restructured post-bankruptcy and is regaining market share in international drilling/completion services; consensus expects margin expansion as offshore activity accelerates. Larger cap (\$7B) and institutional ownership provide liquidity for sustained moves.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Weatherford is a global oilfield services company providing drilling, evaluation, completion, production, and intervention services, primarily in international and offshore markets. Post-bankruptcy restructuring (2019) has returned the company to profitability and growth, with focus on high-margin digital technologies (AI-driven drilling optimization) and international market share gains in underserved geographies.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct Energy sector tailwind (+9.9% vs SPY this week). Exposure to international drilling recovery, offshore activity growth, and AI/digitalization in oilfield services. However, RS of -6.7 vs SPY over 12 weeks indicates lagging performance despite sector strength - this is sector rotation, not company-specific leadership.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$97.77 on vol >2.6x of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume surge to 2.65x and larger float (70.1M) suggest institutional participation, but wide base (base_tight 3.05) indicates no VCP-style absorption. Zero insider buying (cluster 0) despite proximity to earnings (50 days) is a notable absence. Larger mkt cap (\$7B) places this near the top of SMID range, reducing small-cap alpha potential but increasing institutional liquidity and follow-through reliability if the setup triggers.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 50D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

October 20 earnings (50 days) - imminent high-impact catalyst. Consensus expects revenue growth from international market share gains and margin expansion from technology/digital mix shift. If Weatherford delivers a beat and raises guidance on offshore activity acceleration, the stock could re-rate. Beat history over last 4 quarters will determine serial execution credibility.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a daily close below \$92.50 (20MA support and base breakdown), or on any miss or guidance cut at the October 20 print. Wide base (3.05) and negative RS vs SPY (-6.7) suggest this is a sector laggard, not a leader. If Energy sector reverses or oil prices weaken, WFRD will underperform. Market cap near \$7B threshold reduces SMID alpha.

ANALYSIS

Energy sector tailwind (+9.9% vs SPY) and imminent earnings catalyst (Oct 20, 50 days) support the setup. Volume 2.65x, prox_52w 86.4 meet breakout criteria. Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS of -6.7 vs SPY over 12 weeks means this is underperforming the market despite being in the strongest sector - it's a laggard catching up, not leading. Wide base (3.05), no RS line new high, zero insider buying. Sector tailwind earns +0.5 grade bump (C B), and imminent earnings adds tactical appeal, but this is a trade on sector momentum, not a high-conviction position. Conviction: Low

Signal: Close above \$97.77 on vol >2.6x of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 2.65x

